SPECIFICATION OF THE CONTROLLED DESIGNATION OF ORIGIN "SAVENNIÈRES"

approved by decree no. 2011-1099 of 9 September 2011, JORF of 11/09/2011

CHAPTER I

I. – Name of the designation

Only wines meeting the specific provisions set out below may claim the controlled designation of origin "Savennières", initially recognised by the decree of 8 December 1952.

II. – Geographical denominations and complementary terms

The name of the controlled designation of origin may be supplemented by the geographical denomination "Val de Loire" according to the rules fixed in the present specification for the use of this geographical denomination.

III. – Colours and types of product

The controlled designation of origin "Savennières" is reserved for still white wines.

IV. – Areas and zones in which the various operations are carried out

1° – Geographical area

All the steps of the production take place in the geographical area whose perimeter encompasses the territory of the following communes of the Maine-et-Loire department, on the basis of the official geographic code of 2018: Bouchemaine, La Possonnière, Savennières. The cartographic documents representing the geographical area may be consulted on the website of the National Institute of Origin and Quality.

2° – Delimited parcel area

The wines come exclusively from vines situated within the delimited parcel production area as approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the sessions of the competent national committee of 11 and 12 September 1985, 8 and 9 June 2005 and at the session of the standing committee of the competent national committee of 5 September 2007. The National Institute of Origin and Quality lodges with the town halls of the communes referred to in 1° the graphic documents establishing the parcel boundaries of the production area thus approved.

3° – Immediate proximity area

The immediate proximity area, defined by derogation for the vinification, the elaboration and the ageing of the wines, is made up of the territory of the following communes of the Maine-et-Loire department, on the basis of the official geographic code of 2018: Angers, Beaulieu-sur-Layon, Bellevigne-en-Layon (former territories of the delegated communes of Champ-sur-Layon, Faveraye-Mâchelles, Faye-d'Anjou, Rablay-sur-Layon and Thouarcé), Blaison-Saint-Sulpice (former territories of the delegated communes of Blaison-Gohier and Saint-Sulpice), Brissac Loire Aubance (former territories of the delegated communes of Les Alleuds, Brissac-Quincé, Charcé-Saint-Ellier-sur-Aubance, Luigné, Saint-Rémy-la-Varenne, Saint-Saturnin-sur-Loire, Saulgé-l'Hôpital, and Vauchrétien), Chalonnes-sur-Loire, Chaudefonds-sur-Layon, Chemillé-en-Anjou (former territories of the delegated communes of Chanzeaux and Valanjou), Denée, Doué-en-Anjou (former territory of the delegated commune of Brigné), Les Garennes sur Loire (former territories of the delegated communes of Juigné-sur-Loire and Saint-Jean-des-Mauvrets), Mauges-sur-Loire (former territory of the delegated commune of Saint-Laurent-de-la-Plaine), Mozé-sur-Louet, Mûrs-Erigné, Rochefort-sur-Loire, Sainte-Gemmes-sur-Loire, Saint-Melaine-sur-Aubance, Soulaines-sur-Aubance, Terranjou (former territories of the delegated communes of Chavagnes, Martigné-Briand and Notre-Dame-d'Allençon) and Val-du-Layon (former territories of the delegated communes of Saint-Aubin-de-Luigné and Saint-Lambert-du-Lattay).

V. – Grape varieties

The wines come from the chenin B variety.

VI. – Management of the vineyard

1° – Training methods

a) – Planting density.

GENERAL PROVISIONS

The vines present a minimum planting density of 4,000 plants per hectare. These vines may not present a spacing between rows greater than 2.50 metres and a spacing between plants within the same row less than 1 metre.

PARTICULAR PROVISIONS

The vine parcels presenting a planting density lower than 4,000 plants per hectare but greater than or equal to 3,300 plants per hectare benefit, for their harvest, from the right to the controlled designation of origin, subject to compliance with the provisions relating to the trellising and foliage-height rules fixed in the present specification. These vine parcels may not present a spacing between rows greater than 3 metres and a spacing between plants within the same row less than 1 metre.

b) – Pruning rules.

The vines are pruned at the latest on 30 April, by mixed pruning, with a maximum of 12 free eyes (buds) per plant of which a maximum of 4 free eyes on the long cane.

c) – Trellising rules and foliage height.

GENERAL PROVISIONS

The height of the trellised foliage is at least equal to 0.6 times the spacing between rows, the height of trellised foliage being measured between the lower limit of the foliage, established at least 0.40 metre above the ground, and the upper topping limit, established at least 0.20 metre above the upper trellising wire.

PARTICULAR PROVISIONS

The vine parcels whose planting density is lower than 4,000 plants per hectare but greater than or equal to 3,300 plants per hectare moreover meet the following trellising rules: - the minimum height of the trellising posts above ground is 1.90 metre; - obligation of 4 levels of trellising wires; - the minimum height of the last level of wire is 1.85 metre above the ground.

d) – Average maximum load per parcel.

The average maximum load per parcel is fixed at 8,000 kilograms per hectare.

e) – Threshold for missing vines.

The percentage of dead or missing vine plants, referred to in Article D. 645-4 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, is fixed at 20 %.

f) – Overall cultivation condition of the vine.

The parcels are managed so as to ensure a good overall cultivation condition of the vine, in particular its sanitary condition and the upkeep of its soil.

2° – Other cultivation practices

a) – In order to preserve the characteristics of the physical and biological environment that constitutes a fundamental element of the terroir, a plant cover of the headlands is compulsory.

b) – A controlled plant cover, spontaneous or sown, is compulsory on the inter-row; in the absence of this plant cover, the operator carries out a soil tillage so as to ensure the control of the spontaneous vegetation or demonstrates the use of biocontrol products approved by the public authorities in viticulture. In the event of the use of biocontrol herbicides on a parcel, the use of other herbicides is prohibited.

3° – Irrigation

Irrigation is prohibited.

VII. – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes

1° – Harvest

GENERAL PROVISIONS

The wines come from grapes harvested at proper ripeness. The date of the start of the harvest is fixed according to the provisions of Article D. 645-6 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code.

PARTICULAR PROVISIONS

All the grapes arising from the parcels mentioned on the register of production objectives referred to in Chapter II and claimed under the controlled designation of origin "Savennières" are harvested by selection of bunches on the vine. The use of the harvesting machine is prohibited.

2° – Ripeness of the grapes

a) – Sugar richness of the grapes and natural alcoholic strength by volume.
The sugar richness of the grapes and the natural alcoholic strengths by volume meet the following characteristics:

TYPE OF WINE	MINIMUM SUGAR RICHNESS OF THE GRAPES (grams per litre of must)	MINIMUM NATURAL ALCOHOLIC STRENGTH BY VOLUME
Dry wines	186	11.5 %
Other wines	212	12.5 %

b) – Minimum acquired alcoholic strength by volume.
The wines present, after fermentation, a minimum acquired alcoholic strength by volume of 11 %.

VIII. – Yields. – Entry into production

1° – Yield

The yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is fixed at:

TYPE OF WINE	YIELD (hectolitres per hectare)
Dry and medium-dry wines	50
Other wines	35

2° – Limit yield

The limit yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is fixed at:

TYPE OF WINE	LIMIT YIELD (hectolitres per hectare)
Dry and medium-dry wines	50
Other wines	35

3° – Entry into production of young vines

The benefit of the controlled designation of origin may be granted to wines coming from parcels of young vines only from the 2nd year following that in the course of which planting was carried out in place before 31 July.

IX. – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage

1° – General provisions

The wines are vinified in accordance with local, fair and constant usages.

a) – Analytical standards.
The dry wines present, after fermentation, a content of fermentable sugars (glucose + fructose) less than or equal to: - 4 grams per litre; - or 8 grams per litre, when the total acidity content expressed in grams of tartaric acid per litre is not lower by more than 2 grams per litre than the content of fermentable sugars.

b) – Oenological practices and physical treatments.
The use of wood chips is prohibited. The dry wines do not exceed, after enrichment, a total alcoholic strength by volume of 13 %; any enrichment operation is prohibited for the other wines.

c) – Vat capacity.
Every operator has a vinification vat capacity at least equal to 1.4 times the average volume vinified on the holding over the last five years.

d) – Overall upkeep of the cellar (floors and walls) and equipment (hygiene).
The cellar (floors and walls) and the vinification equipment present a good general condition of upkeep.

2° – Provisions by type of product

The wines are the subject of an ageing at least until 15 March of the year following that of the harvest.

3° – Provisions relating to packaging

For each packaged lot, the operator keeps available for the approved control body: - the information appearing in the register of handling operations referred to in Article D. 645-18 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code; - an analysis carried out at packaging. The analysis reports are kept for a period of 6 months from the date of packaging.

4° – Provisions relating to storage

The operator demonstrates a specific place for the storage of the packaged products.

5° – Provisions relating to the movement of products and to placing on the market for the consumer

a) – Date of placing on the market for the consumer.
At the end of the ageing period, the wines are placed on the market for the consumer from 1 April of the year following that of the harvest.

b) – Period during which the wines may move between approved warehouse keepers.
The wines may move between approved warehouse keepers at the earliest on 15 March of the year following that of the harvest.

X. – Link with the geographical area

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The geographical area is situated on the right bank of the Loire, some fifteen kilometres from the town of Angers. It is characterised by a set of hillsides of south/south-east orientation that extend, from the Loire, over a width varying from 500 metres to 1,500 metres and stretch, along the Loire, over about 6 kilometres. To the north of the geographical area, a vast plateau, colder, exposed to the winds, is mainly devoted to stock-rearing and cereal cultivation. The geological substratum is represented by schistose and schisto-sandstone formations of the upper Ordovician to the lower Devonian, locally by volcanic veins (rhyolites and spilites). At the start of the plateau, a few Quaternary aeolian sands were deposited in a more or less thick layer. In a hillside situation, the bedrock is most often very close to the surface. The geographical area extends over the territory of 3 communes: Bouchemaine, La Possonnière and Savennières. The climate is oceanic. The Mauges massif, situated to the west of the vineyard, nuances this oceanic characteristic by a foehn effect. The average annual rainfall is 650 millimetres and characterises an area sheltered from the humid winds, whereas it exceeds 800 millimetres on the hills of the Mauges. This rainfall difference is even more marked during the vegetative cycle of the vine, in particular from the month of June until the harvest period. The average annual temperatures are relatively high (about 12 °C). The Loire plays a preponderant role of temperature regulation on the near hillside, established under the prevailing winds, thus maintaining high night-time temperatures. It also plays an important role by favouring, during the harvest period, the appearance of morning mists, essential for the development of noble rot.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

At first limited to the parcels close to the great abbeys of Angers, the cultivation of the vine spread all around Angers, then over the hillsides of Pruniers and Bouchemaine in the 4th century. Around 1130, the monks of the abbey of Saint-Nicolas d'Angers plant a hillside overlooking the Loire, which will give its name to "La Roche aux Moines". In 1140, Benedictine nuns build, in the town of La Possonnière, a convent named "Le Prieuré". Vast vine "clos" then surround their building. From then on, the wine of "Savennières" is appreciated at the noble tables, and more particularly in the 15th century at the table of the "good king René" (René I of Anjou). The latter, during a halt in the commune, tasting a glass of wine arising from a parcel to the west of the town, qualifies it as a "drop of gold" (goutte d'or). This parcel has been known, since, under the denomination of "Clos de la Goutte d'Or". The vineyard develops especially during the 17th and 18th centuries. Bidet and Duhamel de Monceau, in their "Treatise on the nature and cultivation of the vine" published in 1749, say: "The hillsides that reign along the Loire, on both sides of this river, form the various vineyards of Anjou; these hillsides are ½ league or ¼ league apart from one another, beginning from Angers up to 7 or 8 leagues beyond, towards Brittany. They are but rocks, formerly absolutely sterile, occupied by brushwood, thickets and old trees; which made the country inaccessible and impenetrable, and made it the retreat of all sorts of wild beasts or venomous animals. The terroir, very difficult to clear, is now perfectly cultivated and all planted with vines, up to the place where the hillside begins to flatten and turn towards the north, which extends ¼ league or ½ league…". The hillsides and the lands near the town of Savennières are covered with vine and each dwelling, in the countryside, possesses several plots of vine. On the eve of the Revolution, the "cahiers de doléances", drawn up by the Estates General, give the situation of the vineyard on the hillsides. "Savennières: 2,460 inhabitants, 1/3 in vines of an excellent cru (…) I have not seen a parish more taxed than Savennières", writes then M. Dertrou, syndic. The 19th century sees a profound metamorphosis of viticulture, owing to the substantial progress made in oenology and in plant protection, under the action of owners like Guillory, anxious to obtain quality wines and to maintain the reputation of the wines of "Savennières". Numerous experiments are then carried out, both on the trial of other varieties, with in particular the verdelho of Madeira of which, according to Professor Maisonneuve, some sixty plants were cultivated at the "Coulée de Serrant", and on the layout of terraces or the trials of trellising. Yet, the chenin B variety remains the variety of predilection of the vineyard. Jules Guyot, during one of his visits, in 1865, describes perfectly the training method, speaking thus of a spur pruning, of disbudding, and of a harvest when "a large part of the grapes is over-ripened…". The controlled designation of origin "Savennières" is recognised by the decree of 8 December 1952, which mainly defines the wines with fermentable sugars. This decree has, under the impulse of the successive presidents of the defence union, including Michèle Bazin de Jessey, evolved towards the definition of dry wines, with the possibility of producing wines with fermentable sugars, thus reflecting the practices of the vineyard and the originality of the environment. In 2009, the vineyard is exploited by 34 operators.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the product

The wines are white and most often dry. They may however sometimes present fermentable sugars. They present a robe from pale yellow to golden yellow. The nose is generally characterised by floral aromatic odours or notes (acacia, lime blossom…) mixed with fruity notes that may recall pear, peach, quince, grilled almond, raisin, honey, the whole enhanced by a touch of minerality. The attack on the palate is ample, rich, revealing all the aromatic complexity. The finish is a mixture between freshness, minerality and a hint of bitterness that bring harmony and balance. These wines blossom fully after several years in bottle. The wines presenting fermentable sugars have a remarkable aptitude for ageing.

3° – Causal interactions

The delimited parcel area for the harvesting of the grapes classifies the parcels situated on the sheltered hillsides, well oriented to the south and presenting shallow soils developed on the schistose and schisto-sandstone formations of the primary massif, or shallow soils developed on aeolian sands. These soils, poorly fertile and very stony, have an important drainage capacity and a low water reserve. These viticultural situations impose an optimal management of the plant and of its production potential, reflected in the training of the vine, rigorous pruning rules and a harvest by selection of the bunches, including for the production of dry wines. The know-how of the operators is expressed in their attachment to the chenin B variety, a rustic variety, which finds, in these situations, all its originality and its plenitude. They have adapted to its particularities and to its richness, by diversifying the technical routes. According to the place of establishment, the training of the vine and the climatic conditions of the vintage, the wines elaborated

traditionally present more or less fermentable sugars. When the climatic conditions of the end of harvest are favourable, thanks to the thermoregulatory role of the Loire, to the winds channelled by the river that mechanically favour a desiccation of the berries, or thanks to the presence of morning mists, “moelleux” or “doux” wines are elaborated from berries harvested after concentration by shrivelling on the vine (passerillage) or affected by noble rot under the action of botrytis cinerea. The operators have also very quickly assimilated the techniques enabling them to extract the best from the grapes by adapting their vinification techniques. A period of ageing in vat, after fermentation, has become established to obtain a wine with complex aromas. To reach this objective, a minimum period of ageing until 15 March of the year following that of the harvest is defined in the specification. The conjunction of such a particular natural environment, of a variety perfectly adapted to it and of people who know how to exploit all its potentialities makes it possible to obtain original and singular wines that have a historical notoriety. André Jullien, in 1816, in his “Topography of all the known vineyards”, does not hesitate to class them in the first category, thus recognising their originality, their quality and their reputation. The vineyard of “Savennières”, a symbol of the “douceur angevine”, has been listed since 2001 as a UNESCO World Heritage Site.

XI. – Transitional measures

1° – Training methods

The vine parcels planted at the date of 1 January 1997, presenting a planting density lower than 3,300 plants per hectare, continue to benefit, for their harvest, from the right to the controlled designation of origin until they are grubbed up and at the latest until the 2021 harvest inclusive, subject to meeting the other provisions of the present specification, including all the trellising and foliage-height rules.

2° – Pruning rules

The vine parcels planted before 31 July 1980 may be pruned, until they are grubbed up, with a long cane bearing a maximum of 7 free eyes. In this case, the maximum number of free eyes per plant is fixed at 10 free eyes.

XII. – Rules of presentation and labelling

1° – General provisions

Wines for which, under the terms of the present specification, the controlled designation of origin “Savennières” is claimed and which are presented under the said appellation may not be declared after the harvest, offered to the public, dispatched, put up for sale or sold unless, in the harvest declaration, in advertisements, on leaflets, labels, invoices and any containers whatsoever, the aforesaid controlled designation of origin is entered.

2° – Particular provisions

a) – All the optional indications are entered, on the labels, in characters whose dimensions, both in height and in width, are not greater than double those of the characters composing the name of the controlled designation of origin.

b) – The dimensions of the characters of the geographical denomination “Val de Loire” are not greater, both in height and in width, than two-thirds of those of the characters composing the name of the controlled designation of origin.

c) – The wines are compulsorily presented on the commercial documents, movement documents and on the labelling with the terms “demi-sec”, “moelleux” or “doux” corresponding to the content of fermentable sugars (glucose and fructose) present in the wine, as it is defined by the Community regulations. On the labels, these terms appear in the same visual field as that where the name of the controlled designation of origin is entered.

d) – The labelling of the wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin may specify the name of a smaller geographical unit, subject to: - it being a registered cadastral lieu-dit; - it appearing on the harvest declaration. The name of the registered cadastral lieu-dit is printed in characters whose dimensions

are not greater, both in height and in width, than half those of the characters composing the name of the controlled designation of origin.

CHAPTER II

I. – Declaration obligations

1° – Claim declaration

The claim declaration is sent to the defence and management body at least fifteen days before the marketing of the first lot of the year concerned and at the latest on 31 January of the year following that of the harvest. It indicates: - the appellation claimed; - the volume of the wine; - the EVV and SIRET numbers; - the name and address of the applicant; - the place of storage of the wine. It is accompanied by a copy of the harvest declaration or, as the case may be, a copy of the production declaration or an extract of the stock accounts for the buyers of grapes or musts.

2° – Prior declaration of sale of wines in bulk

The prior declaration of sale of wines in bulk is made to the approved control body. It is either concomitant with the claim declaration (that is to say at the latest on 31 January of the year following that of the harvest) or carried out at least fifteen days before the marketing of the first lots of the year concerned. It comprises the following information (as at the day of the declaration): - the volumes, by controlled designation of origin, intended for sale in bulk; - the volumes, by controlled designation of origin, having already been the subject of a transaction, the name of the buyer and the removal date provided for in the contract.

3° – Declaration relating to the dispatch outside the national territory of a non-packaged wine

Every operator wishing to carry out a dispatch outside the national territory of a non-packaged wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin makes the declaration thereof to the approved control body at least fifteen working days before the dispatch.

4° – Fallback (repli) declaration

Every operator carrying out a fallback of a wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin into a more general controlled designation of origin sends to the defence and management body and to the approved control body a summary table at the latest on 31 January of each year.

5° – Downgrading declaration

Every operator carrying out a downgrading of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin sends to the defence and management body and to the approved control body a summary table at the latest on 31 January of each year.

6° – Declaration of new plantings of vines whose planting density is lower than 4,000 plants per hectare but greater than or equal to 3,300 plants per hectare

This declaration is sent to the defence and management body at the latest on 31 July of the year of planting. It comprises the following information: - the cadastral references of the parcel(s); - the total area.

II. – Keeping of registers

The registers provided for in the present specification are kept and kept available for the officers responsible for the control and communicable at their prior request. They may be kept in any form (paper or computerised).

1° – Parcel monitoring register

This register recalls the information of the CVI record and specifies in particular, for each parcel: - the most restrictive delimited parcel area to which the parcel belongs; - the evaluation of the height of trellised foliage.

2° – Register of production objectives

This register is filled in by the operator before the end of the month of February of the year of harvest. It specifies, for the parcel(s) concerned: - the year of harvest; - the controlled designation of origin; - the cadastral references; - the area.

3° – Ripeness monitoring register

Every operator producing grapes and every operator vinifying wines of the controlled designation of origin keeps up to date a register on which are recorded: - the year of harvest; - for at least one parcel, the results of a ripeness check carried out before harvest: sugar richness of the grapes, density, total acidity or berry-tasting sheet; - per container, the natural alcoholic strength by volume in potential at the filling of the container.

4° – Register of monitoring of the lots intended for a bulk transaction or a packaging

Every operator keeps up to date a register on which are recorded, per lot intended for a bulk transaction or a packaging: - the date of constitution of the lot; - the volume of the lot; - the container(s); - the destination of the lot: bulk transaction (with the identity of the buyer), packaging; - the identity of the laboratory that carried out the chemical analysis of the lot; - the number of the analysis.

CHAPTER III

I. – Main points to be checked and evaluation methods

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
A – STRUCTURAL RULES	
A1 – Delimited parcel area. — Belonging of the planted parcels to the delimited parcel area.	Documentary check and check in the field.
A2 – Claimable production potential. — Grape varieties, monitoring of the transitional measures, planting density and trellising.	Documentary check and/or check in the field.
A3 – Geographical area and immediate proximity area. — Belonging of the processing, ageing, packaging and storage facilities to the geographical area or to the immediate proximity area.	Documentary check and on-site check.
Facilities for monitoring the ripeness and characteristics of the harvest.	Documentary check and on-site check.
Place of vinification and ageing.	Documentary check and on-site check.
B – RULES LINKED TO THE PRODUCTION CYCLE	
B1 – Management of the vineyard. — Pruning.	Check in the field.
Height of trellised foliage.	Documentary check and check in the field.
Average maximum load per parcel.	Check in the field.
Cultivation condition of the vine and other cultivation practices.	Check in the field.
B2 – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes. — Sugar richness of the grapes.	Documentary check (verification of the records kept by the operators) and check in the field (verification at the parcel at harvest).
B3 – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging and storage. — Oenological practices and/or physical treatments (enrichment).	Documentary check and/or on-site check.
B4 – Harvest declaration and claim declaration. — Threshold for missing vines.	Documentary check (keeping of register) and check in the field.
Authorised yield.	Documentary check.
Claim declaration or harvest declaration and coherence with the register of production objectives.	Documentary check.
C – CHECKS ON THE PRODUCTS	
At the stage of the movement of the products between approved warehouse keepers or at the placing on the market for the consumer —	Analytical and organoleptic examination.

non-packaged wines being the subject of a transaction between operators.	
Before or at the stage of the movement of the products between approved warehouse keepers or at the stage of placing on the market for the consumer — wines ready to be placed on the market for the consumer (in bulk or packaged).	Analytical and organoleptic examination.
Non-packaged wines intended for a dispatch outside the national territory.	Analytical and organoleptic examination of all the lots.

II. – References concerning the control structure

National Institute of Origin and Quality (INAO)
TSA 30003
93555 – MONTREUIL-SOUS-BOIS Cedex
Tel: (33) (0)1.73.30.38.00
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The check of compliance with the present specification is carried out by a third-party body offering guarantees of competence, impartiality and independence, under the authority of the INAO, on the basis of an approved inspection plan.

The inspection plan sets out the self-checks carried out by the operators on their own activity and the internal checks carried out under the responsibility of the defence and management body. It indicates the external checks carried out by the third-party body as well as the analytical and organoleptic examinations. The whole of the checks is carried out by sampling. Non-packaged wines intended for a dispatch outside the national territory are the subject of a systematic analytical and organoleptic check.